Incident Response Template (Phishing Incident)

Executive Summary

A phishing email was detected targeting employees within the organization. The email attempted to trick users into clicking a malicious link and submitting login credentials. The SOC team identified the threat, isolated affected systems, and blocked the malicious domain to prevent further compromise.

Timeline

Time	Event
2026-03-18 13:45	Phishing email reported by employee
2026-03-18 14:00	Endpoint isolated
2026-03-18 14:30	Memory dump collected
2026-03-18 15:00	Malicious domain blocked
2026-03-18 15:30	Investigation completed

Impact Analysis

The phishing campaign targeted multiple users in the organization. One endpoint was potentially exposed to credential harvesting. No confirmed data exfiltration occurred. The attack was contained quickly by isolating the affected system and blocking the malicious link.

Remediation Steps

1. Isolated the affected endpoint from the network.
2. Blocked the malicious domain and IP address at the firewall.
3. Reset credentials of the affected user.
4. Updated email filtering rules.
5. Conducted phishing awareness training for employees.

Lessons Learned

The incident highlighted the importance of user awareness and quick incident reporting. Improving phishing detection mechanisms and providing regular security awareness training will help reduce the risk of similar attacks in the future.

Investigation Log

Timestamp	Action
2025-08-18 14:00:00	Isolated endpoint
2025-08-18 14:30:00	Collected memory dump
2025-08-18 15:00:00	Analyzed phishing email headers
2025-08-18 15:20:00	Blocked malicious domain

Phishing Checklist

☐ Confirm email headers
☐ Check link reputation (VirusTotal)
☐ Identify affected users
☐ Block malicious domain
☐ Reset compromised credentials

Post-Mortem

The simulated phishing breach demonstrated the importance of rapid detection and incident response. The SOC team successfully contained the attack by isolating the endpoint and blocking the malicious domain. Future improvements include stronger email filtering, better user awareness training, and faster incident reporting procedures.

Flow Chart

Phishing Email
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User Reports Email
↓
SOC Investigation
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Endpoint Isolation
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Threat Containment
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Post-Incident Review